

Every expression, attitude, and posture in the painting had to be examined and considered down to the smallest detail. Leonardo was very concerned to show the reactions on the disciples' faces, especially the specific expression he should give to the traitor, Judas Iscariot.



The way Leonardo worked depended on his mood. On some days, he would toil from morning till night, paintbrush in hand, never stopping even to eat or drink. On other days, he would stare at the painting for hours, thinking, but never touching the brush at all.

In fact, the prior of the church became impatient seeing Leonardo spend so much time simply staring into space lost in thought. In the prior's view, this could hardly be a good use of

What is a prior?

A prior is a Christian figure in charge of a building, such as a priory or church.